

CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA

SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY → EPISTEMIC GATE → INFERENCE CONTROVERSY → MATERIAL ONTOLOGY → TRANSCENDENT DENIALS → ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Approval: FALSE Pending user review source generation g12 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA prior artefacts unchanged exact same master drives poster and tiles

STAGE 00

SOURCE-CRITICAL ENTRY

RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE LOST BRHASPATI-SŪTRA OPPONENT REPORTS QUOTED FRAGMENTSIMĀDHAVA, JAYANTA, (OFTEN POLEMICAL)DISTINGUISH ATTESTED THESIS FROM HOSTILE CARICATURETHIS-WORLDLY ORIENTATION; CĀRVĀKAMATERIALIST SCHOOL LABEL

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE lost Brhaspati-sūtra opponent reports quoted fragments

Mādhava, Jayanta, (often polemical)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

RULE: distinguish attested thesis from hostile caricature

Lokāyata = this-worldly orientation; Cārvāka = materialist school label.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

CĀRVĀKA / LOKĀYATA: RECONSTRUCTION BEFORE DOCTRINE lost Brhaspati-sūtra opponent reports quoted fragments

Mādhava, Jayanta, (often polemical)

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

STAGE 01

EPISTEMIC GATE

EPISTEMIC GATEVALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCESPERCEPTION ANUMĀNA ŚABDA UPAMĀNA DIRECT, SENSE-GROUNDED INFERENCE TESTIMONY COMPARISONSMOKE IS INVARIABLY FIRE-LINKED.

VALID KNOWLEDGE (PRAMĀ) REJECTED INDEPENDENT SOURCES

PRATYAKṢA / PERCEPTION anumāna śabda upamāna direct, sense-grounded inference testimony comparison observed conjunction is finite

universal vyāpti outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is invariably fire-linked.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

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universal vyāpti outruns perception smoke seen with fire in kitchens != smoke is invariably fire-linked.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats pratyakṣa (perception) as the only independent pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

STAGE 02

INFERENCE CONTROVERSY

INFERENCE CONTROVERSYCĀRVĀKA ATTACKINFERENCE NEEDS UNIVERSAL CONCOMITANCE (VYĀPTI) VYĀPTI KNOWN BY INFERENCEBY PERCEPTIONINCOMPLETE SURVEY HIDDEN CONDITION (UPĀDHI) MAY DEFEAT THE RULEFIRE WITHOUT SMOKE, WET FUEL MATTERSNYĀYA REPLY

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

CĀRVĀKA ATTACK: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) vyāpti known by inference → circularity

by perception → incomplete survey hidden condition (upādhī) may defeat the rule: fire without smoke, wet fuel matters

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

NYĀYA REPLY: repeated agreement + absence of counter-instance + tarka anvaya (presence) + vyatireka (absence) → defeasible but rational vyāpti

CĀRVĀKA COUNTER-PRESSURE: practical expectation may work without certainty

REPLY / RESIDUAL

SELF-REFUTATION CHARGE: arguing against inference already employs inference.

CĀRVĀKA ATTACK: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) vyāpti known by inference → circularity

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: inference needs universal concomitance (vyāpti) vyāpti known by inference – circularity | by perception – incomplete survey hidden condition (upādhī) may defeat the rule: fire without smoke, wet fuel matters.

STAGE 03

MATERIAL ONTOLOGY

MATERIAL ONTOLOGYONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED EARTH + WATER +ORGANISED LIVING BODYCONSCIOUSNESS CONSCIOUSNESS IS A BODY-PROPERTY, NOT AN IMMATERIAL SUBSTANCEFERMENTATION INGREDIENTSINTOXICATING POWER NOT PRESENT SEPARATELY

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living body → consciousness

consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not present separately

ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living

SELF = living conscious body (dehātma-vāda) death → elemental dissolution → no surviving ātman, rebirth or afterlife

QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

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ONLY THIS-WORLDLY ELEMENTS ARE REQUIRED earth + water + fire + air → organised living body → consciousness

consciousness is a body-property, not an immaterial substance analogy: fermentation ingredients → intoxicating power not present separately

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFICATION: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: emergence is asserted; a full mechanism is not supplied.

STAGE 04

TRANSCENDENT DENIALS

TRANSCENDENT DENIALSNO PERCEPTUAL WARRANTNO IMMORTAL SOULNO REBIRTHNO KARMA AS SUPERSENSIBLE MORAL FORCENO HEAVEN/HELLNO POST-MORTEM REWARD OR PUNISHMENTNO CREATOR GOD

NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT

no immortal soul → no rebirth

no karma as supersensible moral force

no heaven/hell → no post-mortem reward or punishment

no creator God → world needs no transcendent planner

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

NO PERCEPTUAL WARRANT

no immortal soul → no rebirth

no karma as supersensible moral force

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

no heaven/hell → no post-mortem reward or punishment

no creator God → world needs no transcendent planner

no Vedic infallibility → priestly testimony lacks intrinsic authority

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — RESULT: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: metaphysics is cut back to perceptible nature and embodied life.

STAGE 05

ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATURE

ETHICS WITHOUT CARICATUREPURUŚĀRTHA FILTER DHARMAREJECTED WHEN GROUNDED IN UNSEEN REWARD OR VEDIC COMMANDREJECTED AS LIBERATION OF A SEPARABLE SOUL ARTHA +INTELLIGIBLE GOODS WITHIN ONE EMBODIED LIFE PRUDENT ENJOYMENTRECKLESS INDULGENCE PLEASURE SOUGHT

WEIGH PAIN, SOCIAL CONSEQUENCE AND ATTAINABLE MEANS

EXAM CONTROL

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

PURUŚĀRTHA FILTER dharmā: rejected when grounded in unseen reward or Vedic command mokṣa: rejected as liberation of a separable soul artha + kāma: intelligible goods within one embodied life prudent enjoyment != reckless indulgence pleasure sought

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

→ weigh pain, social consequence and attainable means

EXAM CONTROL: call it naturalistic hedonism or this-worldliness

EVALUATION / TRAP

do not reduce the school to the hostile slogan “eat, drink and borrow.”

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

STAGE 06

COMPARATIVE PRESSURE MAP

COMPARATIVE PRESSURE MAPISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM PRAMĀṆA PERCEPTION ONLY FOUR PRAMĀṆASANTI-DOGMATIC EVIDENTIAL DISCIPLINEPERCEPTION-ONLY RULE STRUGGLES TO JUSTIFY SCIENCE, MEMORY AND ITS

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

ISSUE CĀRVĀKA NYĀYA BUDDHISM pramāṇa perception only four pramāṇas perception + inference self conscious body enduring ātman anātman

stream causation observed sequence realist relation dependent origination transcendent denied God, soul, karma karma without creator liberation death

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

ends person apavarga nirvāṇa

STRENGTH: anti-dogmatic evidential discipline

REPLY / RESIDUAL

LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

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MECHANISM / VERDICT — LIMIT: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: perception-only rule struggles to justify science, memory and its own critique.

STAGE 07

PYQ ANSWER RAIL

PYQ ANSWER RAILDEFINE SOURCE PROBLEMSTATE PERCEPTION THESISRECONSTRUCT INFERENCE ATTACK EXPLAIN UPĀDHI/CIRCULARITYGIVE NYĀYA REPLYASSESS SELF-REFUTATION DERIVE MATERIALISMEMBODIED SELFTRANSCENDENT DENIALS

DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain upādhī/circularity → give

assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical result

QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive pratyakṣa criterion is narrower

needed to defend that challenge.

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain upādhī/circularity → give Nyāya reply →

assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical result

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive pratyakṣa criterion is narrower than the reasoning

needed to defend that challenge.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

DEFINE source problem → STATE perception thesis → RECONSTRUCT inference attack explain upādhī/circularity → give Nyāya reply →

assess self-refutation derive materialism → embodied self → transcendent denials → ethical result

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFIED VERDICT: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive pratyakṣa criterion is narrower than the reasoning needed to defend that challenge.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka is a rigorous empiricist challenge, but its exclusive pratyakṣa criterion is narrower than the reasoning needed to defend that challenge.

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT1. HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM2. EPISTEMOLOGY — PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE PRAMĀṆA3. THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE — VYĀPTI, UPĀDHI4. THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE — AND A5. METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM — FOUR BHŪTAS, THE6. SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS — DEHĀTMAVĀDA, AND7. THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES — GOD, SOUL

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

1. Historical Reconstruction and the Source Problem

2. Epistemology — Perception as the Sole Pramāṇa

3. The Critique of Inference — Vyāpti, Upādhī, the Socrates Syllogism and Self-Refutation

4. The Nyāya Defence of Inference — and a Critically Balanced Verdict

ADVANCED OBJECTION

5. Metaphysics and Materialism — Four Bhotas, the Rejection of Ākāśa, and Svabhāva-vāda

6. Self, Body and Consciousness — Dehātma-vāda, and Cārvāka versus Buddhist Anātman (2024, 20 marks)

7. The Rejection of Transcendent Entities — God, Soul, Karma, Rebirth, Heaven, Mokṣa, Veda and Ritual

8. Ethics and the Political-Social Meaning — and Cārvāka versus Jaina Reality (2020, 15 marks)

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

9. Comparative Synthesis and Answer-Writing Architecture

A genuine early principle of epistemic economy: do not multiply unseen entities without warrant.

A real and still powerful problem about the warrant for universals and vyāpti.

A valuable naturalistic check on speculative metaphysics, ritualism, and unverifiable claims.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.